▼ GLASSHOUSE



FAREWELL, COMRADE

A day after election results pronounced the end of the Left regime in Kerala, outgoing chief minister **Pinarayi Vijayan** returned to state capital Thiruvananthapuram from his constituency Dharmadom. At the airport, the octogenarian leader was greeted by senior CPI(M) colleagues, a far cry from the heavy security and fanfare that marked his arrival till yesterday. This was not how it was supposed to end. Having survived a scare in his own bastion, Pinarayi appeared weary, smiling only briefly, avoiding any interaction, and leaving in a party vehicle. Once back, the Left veteran did not waste any time, swiftly vacating the CM's official residence, Cliff House, and moving to a third-floor flat at the party-owned Chintha Apartments, allotted to him in his capacity as a CPI(M) politburo member. Why, if party sources are to be believed, Pinarayi may even refuse Leader of the Opposition position, citing health concerns.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ AI-CATCHERS

CHARM INC.

Once mocked for his drone-like speeches, Andhra Pradesh CM **N. Chandrababu Naidu** is now adopting a more engaging, some may say even amusing, register in his public addresses. At Visakhapatnam, launching the $15 billion (Rs 1.4 lakh crore) Google Cloud AI hub with AdaniConneX and Airtel Nxtra, he quipped: "The world searches on Google. Google has searched and chosen



Visakhapatnam." Calling the hub "Bharat's growth engine", he linked it to his 1990s IT push in Hyderabad. Naidu even predicted that AI tutors and doctors would become "routine", adding that he would soon have to recruit an AI aide to work alongside his four secretaries. In the same vein, he set a September 2028 deadline for the project and publicly nudged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to come and inaugurate it.